

But maybe you're one of the idealistic lovebirds who think they can have it all. You want a storybook romance, but you're also smart with your money and have no intention of making a stupid decision that you'll be paying for for the rest of your life. You're determined not to let your parents meddle in your love life, because you're convinced you are fully capable of finding a sizzling romantic partner with whom you can *also* build a sizable financial dynasty. As far as you're concerned, that's what marriage *is*. "Uncle Kevin," you cry, "I don't care if she's poor; I love her!" Fine. Be a sap, if you must. But find someone who *will* participate in your financial future, and enlist them in every step of the process. If you are missing the money piece, you are making a huge mistake—and you need help. Lucky for you, Uncle Kevin is here.

Money Mistake: *You're Missing the Money Piece of Finding a Mate*

The Fix: *Outsource It*

In many cultures, the matchmaker has always been a highly respected member of the community. In Japan, the *nakodo* acts as a go-between, and in China people pay tribute to Nu Gua, the goddess of matchmakers. Matchmaking has a long, illustrious history, and I'm not the first to suggest that they kind of had it right. Traditionally, matchmakers work alongside the parents and relatives on both sides to ensure a strong, lasting union. As your matchmaker, I'm going to dispense some invaluable money advice, but I'm also going to suggest that if you trust your family, you enlist their help—after all, these are the people who know you best.

Remember how I told you to make the Relationship Due Diligence checklist a mandatory part of dating? Now you don't have to, because your mother's going to do it for you! In an arranged marriage, your family and the matchmaker take care of the due diligence, and they do it long before you're even involved. They're going to get the dirt on your partner's family background, spending habits and financial history. Connecting two families can be very powerful, so they have every reason to take their time and do a